

How to Deliver a Successful Speech?

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Choosing a Topic

- Before you begin writing your speech, you must first establish the main topic about which you plan to speak.
- Brainstorm early and often!
- Once you start to get an idea of your topic, do a little preliminary research.



Preparing a Speech

- Organize your speech in a logical sequence: opening, main points, summary.
- Stick to a timeline
- You can move from broad points to specific points, or vice versa, depending on the effect you are trying to achieve and the argument you are trying to make.
- Practice and rehearse.
- Ask friends to be your audience, or practice in front of a mirror.
- Be sure to use a timer to help you pace your speech.



- Become familiar with the stage or the setting where the speech will take place.
- Get a sense of the size of the stage, where any steps or obstacles might be, and where to enter and exit.
- Choose comfortable clothes to wear, but always maintain a professional appearance.
- Visual aids should fit a speech.
- The main goal of visual aids is to help the audience understand what is being said and reinforce the points of a speech in unique and interesting ways.



Successful Speeches

Whether you're talking to a small group of people or speaking to a large audience, you want to be sure your speech is memorable and enjoyable.

- Be prepared. Your audience is giving you their time and consideration, so rehearse enough to be confident you'll leave a good impression.
- Start strong. Begin your speech with a powerful opening that will grab your audience's attention, such as an interesting story or a funny joke.



- Be familiar. Avoid reading your speech word for word. Instead, refer to notes or points from an outline to help your speech have a more free-flowing, conversational tone.
- Speak with passion. If you're truly invested in what you're saying, you'll be better able to keep your audience's attention.
- Be patient. It's easy to get frustrated if you make a mistake. But remember that public speaking is not easy, and it takes time to improve your skills. Keep practicing and you will reach your goals.
- Show your personality. Your acceptance speech should come from the heart.

Gestures or Body Language

- Speakers generate a great amount of emotion and interest with non-verbal communication, often called gestures or body language.
- A speaker's body can be an effective tool for emphasizing and clarifying the words they use, while reinforcing their sincerity and enthusiasm.
- Be mindful of body language, eye contact and personal space. Posture, mannerisms and eye contact speak volumes and what is taken for granted in one culture might be considered offensive in another.

- Eye contact establishes an immediate bond with an audience, especially when a speaker focuses in on individual listeners rather than just gazing over the audience.
- Control mannerisms. Mannerisms are the nervous expressions a speaker might not be aware of such as putting their hands in their pockets, nodding their head excessively, or using words like *um* and *ah* too often.





- Put words into action when speaking to an audience by physically acting them out with the hands, face or entire body.
- Avoid insincere gestures by involving the entire body as much as possible in the movement and matching facial expressions to it.
- Move around the stage as topics change and move toward the audience when asking questions, making critical connections, or offering a revelation.
- Know your audience. Avoid using too much industry jargon or material that is too technical for your colleagues to easily understand.
- Try to convey a message through your speech.

- Don't speak too fast.
- Be careful with metaphors. Some metaphors that are appropriate in one culture can be offensive to another
- Know the meanings of words outside your native language. Unless you are sure of the meaning and pronunciation of a word you are using in each language, do not use it. In some languages, slight variations of a vowel will completely alter the meaning of a word.



Important

- Know your audience
- Select a topic
- Organize – opening, main points, summary
- Prepare
- Rehearse
- Use a timer to help you pace your speech
- Eye contact
- Gestures and facial expressions
- Vocal Variety
- Interaction with the audience

Practice, Practice, and Practice !



References

- <https://courses.lumenlearning.com/boundless-communications/chapter/steps-of-preparing-a-speech/>
- <https://www.toastmasters.org/resources/public-speaking-tips>
- <https://www.ted.com/talks>
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bbz2boNSeL0&t=2s>

*All the great
speakers were
bad speakers
at first.*

-Ralph Waldo Emerson

